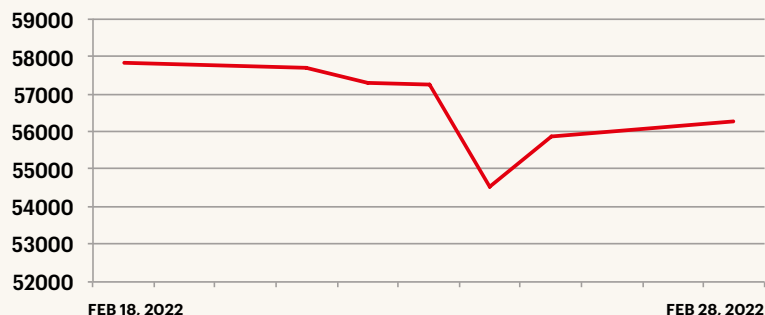




SENSEX GETS THE SHIVERS

The index fell 2,702 points on February 24 after Russia launched an attack on Ukraine

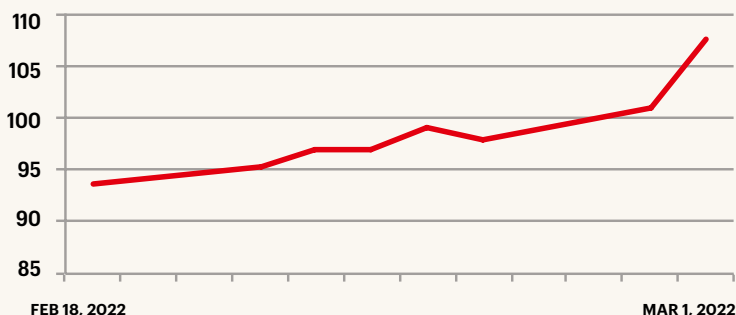


SOURCE ACE EQUITY



OIL PRICES SURGE

Crude prices have jumped since the conflict began, hitting \$107.43 on March 1

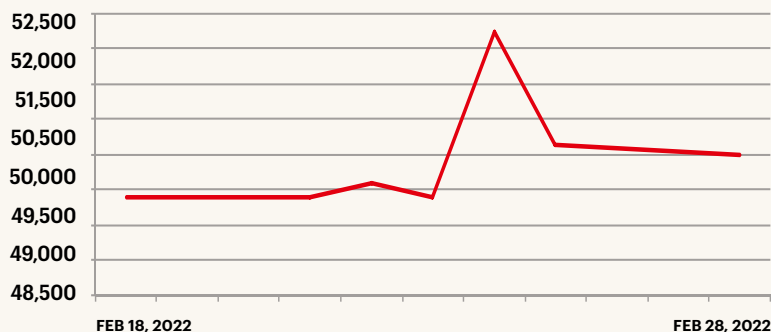


PRICE OF BRENT CRUDE AT \$ PER BARREL AT CLOSE OF TRADE;
SOURCE INVESTING.COM



GOLD SHINES BRIGHT

The price of gold rose nearly 5 per cent on February 24 after the conflict started



AHMEDABAD SPOT PRICE IN ₹ per 10 gm; SOURCE MCX

nearly \$591 million in FY21, with YoY growth of 6.95 per cent.

A majority of domestic players do business in both countries, including Dr. Reddy's Laboratories and Sun Pharma. "We have had a strong presence in the region for over three decades. Ensuring the well-being of our staff is the first and foremost priority, along with meeting patient needs and business continuity. We have been monitoring developments closely and preparing accordingly," a spokesperson for Dr. Reddy's told *BT*.

Exports of tea—incidentally called *chai* in both Russian and Ukrainian—may also face a challenge. Russia is one of the biggest importers of Indian tea with a share of 18 per cent in Indian tea exports. "The Russian market is crucial for Indian tea exports given the fact that Iran shipments continue to be plagued by payment issues, which have resulted in drastic fall in export volumes," says Chinmoy Dhar, Secretary, India Tea Association.

There is some bad news for health-conscious Indians, as the country depends almost totally on Ukraine and Russia for sunflower oil imports. In 2020-21, India imported 1.9 million tonnes of crude sunflower oil, of which Ukraine accounted for 1.4 million tonnes. The rest came from Russia. Sudhakar Desai, president of the Indian Vegetable Oil Producers' Association, says, "Currently, India has stocks that could last until end of March... An alternative solution is to divert supply from Argentina or other places to meet demand. We could also look at replacing sunflower oil with palm, mustard, soya oil, etc."

In case Russia and Ukraine do not arrive at a resolution soon, there is a possibility of the conflict spilling beyond the region. And that would be bad news for businesses. But whether or not the conflict prolongs or ceases quickly, it might have fast-tracked a chain of events that redefines geopolitics for the long term in the 21st century. **BT**

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